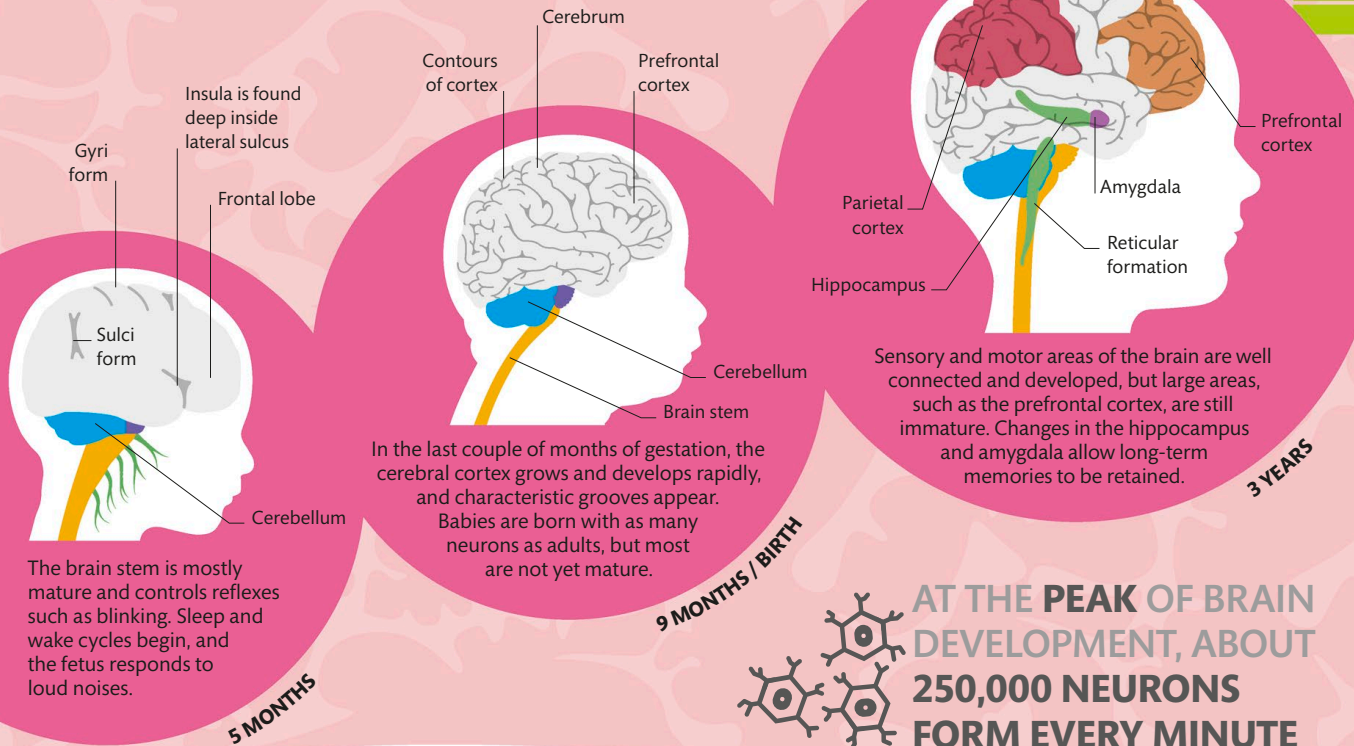




Children's brains

After birth, babies' brains are like sponges; they are incredible at taking in information from the world around them and trying to make sense of it. During the first few years, the brain grows and develops rapidly, with brain volume doubling in the first year of life. Synapses grow and form new connections quickly and easily, a process called neuroplasticity.

Building connections

Peak plasticity for each region of the brain is different. Sensory areas build synapses rapidly four to eight months after birth, but prefrontal areas do not reach peak plasticity until an infant is around 15 months old.



NEWBORN



9 MONTHS



2 YEARS

WHY IS OUR BRAIN WRINKLY?

As human intelligence evolved, our cortex expanded. But bigger heads would mean that babies could not fit through the birth canal. A folded cortex packs more tissue into a smaller volume.